



Ohio River Trail Council

Butterfly - Hummingbird Garden Project



Lock 57 Park, Ohioville Pa.

Press Release

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

July 5, 2011

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OHIO RIVER TRAIL RECEIVES SUPPORT FROM VENTURE OUTDOORS

Monaca, Pa. (July 5, 2011) The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) has received a \$1000 grant from Venture Outdoors to initiate the ORTC Butterfly, Hummingbird and Wildflower Project. This grant was provided by the VO Environmental Catalyst Program funded by the Colcom Foundation. The Ohio River Trail Council supports the development of Butterfly, Hummingbird and Wildflower Gardens and Preserves along the proposed Ohio River Trail. The gardens located in the ORTC partner communities in Allegheny and Beaver County will contain a large variety of nectar plants (food plants) and host plants (the plants that butterflies lay eggs on) to attract butterflies and hummingbirds.

Ohioville Mayor John Szatkiewicz, Vice President of the Ohio River Trail Council, indicated that planting of the trees, vines, shrubs, and perennial wildflowers at Lock 57 Community Park, Ohioville Pa began on Thursday June 30, 2011 by Boy Scout Troop 425, Western Beaver High School Ecology Club, and the Independence Conservancy. Other volunteers included Linda Tice, Cherie Conrad and Jennifer Emmerling. Dr. Vincent Troia stated "that the ORTC project committee, co-chaired by himself and John Szatkiewicz, included expert design work and plant selection from Karen Atkins

the owner of Proper Gardens, Pam Varga a master gardener from the Penn State Extension and Dino De Ciantis the Director of the Penn State Center. The committee's goal was to provide park visitors the opportunity to enjoy wildflowers and wildlife from early spring to late fall."

The ORTC is dedicated to the beautification of all its partner communities. Our members are volunteers who donate their time and talents. Their personal participation in these projects creates a sense of ownership and promotes civic pride. We are fortunate to live in such a beautiful part of the country. Sometimes we take for granted the many natural resources that can make southwestern Pennsylvania so attractive to new businesses, families and visitors. Maintaining the natural beauty of our communities is a responsibility that should be shared by all. It should be taught within our families and supported throughout our neighborhoods. I would like to invite you to become a member of the ORTC and support our efforts.



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